when functional. Indian Immunologicals Limited in Hyderabad was also provided ₹60 crore and Bharat Immunologicals and Biologicals Limited was supported with a grant of ₹30 crore to manufacture about 1.5 crore doses per month. In addition, Gujarat Biotechnology Research Centre tied up with Hester Biosciences and Omnibrx acquired technology from Bharat Biotech to produce about two crore doses per month.

The prime minister spent some time with the entire team of scientists at Bharat Biotech since they were quite enthusiastic to meet him and took a tour of the facility where he was explained the step-by-step production process. By 4.00 p.m., he left the facility—greeting the enthusiastic crowd that had gathered outside to see him—for Hakimpet airbase, from where he was scheduled to fly to Pune.

By 5.15 p.m., the prime minister had arrived at the Pune airbase, from where he boarded a chopper to make way to the manufacturing facility of the SII, covering a distance of about 10 kilometre. At SII, he was greeted by Chairman Cyrus Poonawalla, his son and CEO Adar Poonawalla and Adar's wife and executive director, Natasha Poonawalla. After being given a tour of the facility, the team expressed its confidence in ensuring adequate supplies and how it was looking forward to rising to the occasion to supply vaccines to India and the world. By November, SII had stockpiled about four crore doses, confident of Phase III trials yielding positive data and had majorly augmented their production unit with an ability to produce over 40 crore doses by July 2021. In an effort to assist SII to further ramp up production, the prime minister committed to provide advance funding to the tune of ₹1,200 crore for about six crore doses. Mr Adar Poonawalla later confirmed, 'I used these funds to further ramp up my infrastructure and purchase raw materials and machines at a premium cost, so that India could receive the vaccines in the shortest possible time.' By the time the meeting concluded, the prime minister had spent more time than was scheduled in his three-city visit. Unfortunately, due to take-off restrictions around sunset and delay in his schedule, he couldn't board the chopper and had to make the journey back to the airbase from where he was scheduled to fly back to New Delhi, by car, taking much longer than planned.

In the case of all the three companies, in response to requests for assistance in timely regulatory approvals, the prime minister made it abundantly clear to them, 'We are in the midst of a once-in-a-century pandemic. The GoI will ensure that there is no red-tape and no hold-up due